CLB

CRISTIAN LA BELLA

AEROSPACE & DEFENSE MANUFACTURING CONSULTING

PRACTICE	REGION	EXPERIENCE
AEROSPACE CONSULTING	GLOBAL - ASIA / MIDDLE EAST / EUROPE	20+ YEARS

FREE FIELD TOOL | QUICK START GUIDE

ISO 9001:2015 Gap Assessment *Workbook*

A practical guide to running a clause-by-clause readiness check against ISO 9001:2015: how to set up the workbook, record findings honestly, read the results and use AI safely.

36	4-10	4	FREE
CHECKPOINTS	ISO 9001 CLAUSES	WORKBOOK SHEETS	TO USE

© 2026 Cristian La Bella Consulting. All rights reserved.

cristianlabella.com

VERSION 1.0 | OCTOBER 2026

01 What this workbook is

The ISO 9001:2015 Gap Assessment Workbook is a free Excel field tool for checking how ready an organization is against ISO 9001:2015, clauses 4 to 10. For each requirement it gives you an audit question, a list of objective evidence to ask for, the findings seen most often in practice and a follow-up question to test depth. It is designed for a structured conversation on the shop floor, not for a desk exercise.

Who it is for

- **Quality and operations managers** preparing for a certification, surveillance or customer audit.
- **Internal auditors and consultants** running readiness assessments for a client or a site.
- **Small and mid-size suppliers**, including aerospace and defense supply chains, building a sound ISO 9001 base before moving to sector standards such as AS9100D.

What is inside

SHEET	WHAT IT DOES
Instructions	How to use the workbook, the status values, a legend and one completed example row.
Summary	Client, site, auditor and date, plus automatic results by clause: counts per status, assessed % and conformity %.
Checklist	36 checkpoints across clauses 4 to 10, each with the requirement (paraphrased), audit question, evidence to request, common findings and follow-up questions, followed by your input columns.
AI Use Guide	Where AI helps in an audit workflow, the guardrails to respect and starter prompts.

Coverage by clause

4 Context	5 Leadership	6 Planning	7 Support	8 Operation	9 Performance evaluation	10 Improvement	Total
4	3	3	7	12	4	3	36

What you need

- The workbook in **Excel** (desktop version recommended; the dropdowns and formulas work best there).
- A **licensed copy of ISO 9001:2015** to check any requirement you are unsure about.
- Access to the **process owners and their records** for the scope you chose, so evidence can be seen, not described.

> **BEFORE YOU START**
>
> Clause text in the workbook is **paraphrased for field use**. Always verify requirements against the licensed standard, which you can obtain from ISO or your national standards body. The workbook supports, and does not replace, auditor judgment. Findings are **indicative**, not a certification decision.

© 2026 Cristian La Bella Consulting. All rights reserved. | cristianlabella.com

02 Run an assessment in five steps

1	**Set up**	On the Summary sheet, enter the client, site or scope, auditor and assessment date. Decide the boundary first: one process, one department or one site. A narrow scope gives sharper results than a vague one.
2	**Assess**	On the Checklist sheet, work clause by clause. Ask the audit question, request the evidence listed, compare what you see with the common findings and use the follow-up question to test how deep the system really goes.
3	**Record**	Fill the shaded cream cells only: Status (dropdown), Evidence seen / notes, Owner and Target date. Everything else is reference content or formulas.
4	**Review**	The Summary sheet updates automatically from your statuses: counts per clause, assessed % and conformity %.
5	**Act**	Turn every gap into an action with an owner and a date. Re-assess the same clauses after the actions are closed to confirm the gap is really gone.

The five status values

Conforming	The requirement is met and you saw the evidence yourself.
Minor gap	The requirement is partly met, or the lapse is isolated. The system still works overall.
Major gap	The requirement is missing, or the lapse is systemic or puts conformity of product at risk.
Not applicable	The requirement does not apply to the scope. Justify it in the notes (for example, design excluded from scope under 8.3).
Not assessed	Default value. Not yet checked, so it is left out of the percentage until you assess it.

These descriptions are working guidance. The final classification of any finding remains the auditor's judgment.

TIP FOR THE CHECKLIST SHEET

Use the **Common findings** column as a search list, not a script. If the organization is clean on the usual traps, push further with the **Follow-up** question. The most useful notes come from asking to *see* a record or to *observe* an operation, not from asking whether a procedure exists.

© 2026 Cristian La Bella Consulting. All rights reserved. | cristianlabella.com

03 Read the results and score honestly

The Summary sheet shows, for each clause, how many items are conforming, minor gap, major gap, not applicable and not assessed, with a conformity percentage. It also gives the total assessed % and the number of open gaps (minor plus major).

> **HOW CONFORMITY % IS CALCULATED**
>
> **Conformity % = Conforming ÷ (Items - Not applicable - Not assessed)**
> Items with no status yet are excluded until you assess them. A high conformity % means little if the **Assessed %** is low, so read the assessed % first. The result is an indicative readiness measure, not a certification outcome.

Scoring honestly

- **Score what you saw, not what is written.** A procedure on file is not evidence that it is followed.
- **No evidence, no "Conforming".** If you could not see the record or observe the activity, use Minor gap or leave it as Not assessed.
- **Sample independently.** Pick the records yourself (for example, five gauges at random) instead of accepting the ones offered.
- **Do not use "Not applicable" to skip hard clauses.** Every use needs a written justification tied to the scope.
- **Write specific notes:** what you checked, how many, which record, what was missing. Another person should be able to repeat your check.

A completed row

CLAUSE	**7.1.5 Monitoring and measuring resources**
STATUS	**Minor gap**
EVIDENCE SEEN / NOTES	Calibration register reviewed; 3 of 40 gauges past due date (micrometers M-12, M-17, M-22). No impact assessment on file for M-17 found out of tolerance in March.
OWNER	Quality Manager
TARGET DATE	2026-11-30

Why this row works: it names the records reviewed, gives counts and references, states the gap in terms of evidence, and gives a named owner and a date.

Common mistakes

- Assessing every clause in one sitting with a single person. Involve the process owners for 7, 8 and 9.
- Reading the Summary as a pass or fail result. It points to where to look first; it does not decide certification.
- Closing gaps on paper only. Re-check the evidence after the corrective action is complete.

© 2026 Cristian La Bella Consulting. All rights reserved. | cristianlabella.com

04 Using AI safely in an audit workflow

The workbook includes an AI Use Guide sheet. AI can save preparation time, but only if you keep confidential data out of it and keep the judgment with the auditor.

WHERE AI HELPS	GUARDRAILS
Draft questions tailored to a process or product. **Evidence lists** built from a clause, to send before the audit. **Finding wording** drafted from your raw notes. You verify every word. **Summaries** of long procedures or earlier reports.	**Confidentiality.** Do not enter client names, part numbers, drawings, contract terms or export-controlled data. Sanitize first (“Client A”, “Part X”). **Verification.** AI can misstate requirements. Check every clause reference against the licensed standard. **Judgment.** Classifying findings and drawing conclusions stays with the auditor. **Record.** Note in the audit file where AI assisted the drafting.

STARTER PROMPT: EVIDENCE REQUEST

“Act as an ISO 9001:2015 auditor. For clause 8.4, list the documents and records I should request from a small machining supplier. Use generic placeholders; no client data.”

05 Next steps

- **Download the workbook:** cristianlabella.com/downloads/ISO9001_2015_Gap_Assessment_v1.0_Protected.xlsx
- **Take the free Manufacturing Readiness Assessment** (24 questions, about 5 minutes) at cristianlabella.com/assessment.html
- **Share your feedback.** If you use the workbook on a real assessment, I would value your comments on what worked and what was unclear.
- **Coming next:** an AS9100D version is planned.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Cristian La Bella is an aerospace and defense manufacturing consultant with 20+ years of hands-on experience across engineering, industrialization, production and quality, and holds ISO 9001, 14001 and 45001 auditor certifications. Contact: cristianlabella.com/contact.html

Copyright and use. © 2026 Cristian La Bella Consulting. All rights reserved. This guide and the workbook are free to use for your own audit preparation and internal assessments. Please do not sell, republish or modify them without written permission.

Disclaimer. This guide and the workbook are for general professional and informational purposes. They do not constitute certification, legal, regulatory or compliance advice, and results are indicative only. This guide does not reproduce ISO 9001:2015, which must be obtained from ISO or a national standards body. ISO and all standards and third-party names remain the property of their respective owners.